

# Know Your Rights In Long-Term Care

(continued)

## ACCESS

Have visitors of their choosing and participate in community, religious, and social activities.

## MANAGE FINANCES

Control personal finances and receive statements for services and charges.

## PRIVACY

Maintain privacy in personal, financial, and medical matters.

## MAKE COMPLAINTS

File complaints and have them investigated without retaliation.

## TO REMAIN

Stay in their adult care home unless proper discharge procedures are followed.

*All residents have the right to exercise these rights without interference, coercion, discrimination, or retaliation.*

## NEED HELP?

Contact the Kansas Long-Term Care Ombudsman Program

[WWW.OMBUDSMAN.KS.GOV](http://WWW.OMBUDSMAN.KS.GOV)



## CONTACT US



### PHONE

785-296-3017 / 877-662-8362



### WEBSITE

[www.ombudsman.ks.gov](http://www.ombudsman.ks.gov)



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## Advocating for Residents in Long-Term Care

An Ombudsman is a trained advocate who helps people living in nursing homes, assisted living communities, and other long-term care settings.

Ombudsmen listen to concerns, protect resident rights, and help resolve problems.

[WWW.OMBUDSMAN.KS.GOV](http://WWW.OMBUDSMAN.KS.GOV)

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## How Do Ombudsmen Help?



### ADVOCATE

We advocate for residents' civil and human rights and give a voice to those who might otherwise go unheard.



### INVESTIGATE

Certified staff and trained volunteers investigate complaints and work to resolve concerns based on the resident's wishes.



### EDUCATE

Ombudsmen provide education about long-term care issues and advocate for improvements in policies and services.

## How We Work With Residents

Ombudsman staff and volunteers are trained in:

- Resident rights
- Problem solving
- Communication
- Negotiation and mediation

They improve quality of life by:

- Listening to concerns from residents and families
- Helping resolve problems with care or services
- Working with facility staff to find solutions
- Supporting residents in making informed decisions

Solutions are always **person-centered** and **directed by the resident's wishes**.

## Know Your Rights In Long-Term Care

Residents living in long-term care facilities have important rights protected by law. These rights help ensure dignity, safety, and quality of life.

### DIGNITY

Be treated with dignity and respect, free from abuse, neglect, exploitation, and unnecessary restraints.

### PERSONAL CARE

Develop their own care plan, choose providers, and refuse or stop treatments or medications.

### PERSONAL SPACE

Have a safe living environment and access to personal belongings and equipment.

### LIFESTYLE

Make choices about daily schedules, activities, and participation in family or resident groups.

### BE FULLY INFORMED

Receive information about treatment, care plans, medical status, and access to personal records.

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## When Should You Contact an Ombudsman?

Contact an Ombudsman if you:

- Have concerns about care
- Believe a resident's rights are being ignored
- Need help resolving a problem with a facility
- Have questions about long-term care services

Services are **free** and **resident-directed**.

